MILITARY SPECIFICATION

INSIGNIA, DISTINCTIVE UNIT AND SHOULDER LOOP

This specification is approved for use within the Department of the Army and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification establishes the requirements for distinctive unit insignia (DUI) and shoulder loop insignia (SLI).

1.2 Classification. The insignia covered by this specification shall be of the following types:

Type I - Distinctive Unit Insignia
Type II - Shoulder Loop Insignia ROTC

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. Specifications and standards form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiber board
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: Director, The Institute of Heraldry, US Army, Cameron Station, Alexandria, VA 22304-5050, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8455
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STANDARDS

FEDERAL

MIL-STD-151 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

MILITARY

MIL-STD- 129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-2073 - DOD Materiel Procedures for Development and Application of Packaging Requirement

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents and drawings form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

DRAWINGS

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY, US ARMY

B-13-12 - Attaching Device, Heraldic Prong and Clutch Type
Unnumbered - Distinctive Unit Insignia, for each Unit Insignia
Unnumbered - Shoulder Loop Insignia, for each School Insignia

STANDARDS

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY, US ARMY

TIOH Standard Color Chips

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODIS shall be the issue of the nongovernment documents which is current on the date of the solicitation.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

ASTM-D-3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging.

(Application for copies of ASTM publications should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103).

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(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets or MS standards), the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Detail requirements for individual insignia. The detail requirements or exceptions for a particular insignia shall be as specified on the applicable drawing. In the event of a conflict between the specification and the applicable drawing, the manufacturing requirements on the drawing shall govern.

3.2 Standard sample. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the contracting officer will furnish a standard sample for matching color and finish only. When no standard sample is available, a drawing 6 times actual size will be furnished for color location.

3.3 First article. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3 and 6.4).

3.4 Materials. Materials shall conform to reference specifications and requirements specified herein.

3.4.1 Gilding metal. Gilding metal shall be free from pits, scale (including red oxide), dents, nicks, scratches, segregations and foreign inclusions. The chemical composition shall be as shown in table I, when tested as specified in 4.4.7.1.

TABLE I. Chemical composition of gilding medal.

Alloy	Copper	Lead (max.)	Iron (max.)	Other (max).	Zinc
Gilding medal	94.0 to 96.0	.03	.05	.13	Remainder

3.4.2 Gold (for plating). Gold for plating shall be 24 karat.

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3.4.3 Nickel (for plating). Nickel for plating shall be the nickel plate normally used in commercial practice.

3.4.4 Solder.

3.4.4.1 Hard solder. Hard solder shall be silver solder having a melting point of not less than 1065 degrees F.

3.4.4.2 Soft solder. Soft solder shall be a tin-lead alloy having a melting point of not less than 375 degrees F.

3.4.5 Enamel. Enamel shall be a hard fired vitreous type enamel fused with metallic oxides to produce the required color, shade, opacity or translucence. Enamel colors shall match the TIOH color chips specified and match the standard or approved guide sample.

3.4.6 Silver (for plating). The silver for plating, when required, shall be not less than 99.0 percent pure silver.

3.4.7 Lacquer. When lacquer is used, the lacquer shall be a pale, clear synthetic lacquer. The use of pigmented lacquer shall not be permitted.

3.5 Rivets. When rivets are used to attach a superimposed device to the base, the rivets may be made from any type brass or nickel silver. At the option of the manufacturer, either solid or hollow rivets may be used.

3.6 Design. The design of all distinctive unit insignia shall be an exact replica of the design of the Government furnished die. The die for shoulder loop insignia will be made by the contractor and will be manufactured in accordance with the Government furnished six times actual size drawing. The Government does not furnish tools for shoulder loop insignia.

3.7 Construction.

3.7.1 Stamping, trimming and piercing. Stamping shall be accomplished in a manner to insure a well defined die-struck edge. The stamping shall be trimmed and when applicable, pierced to the die-struck outline. All edges shall be clean, smooth and free from burrs, drag marks, steps and rough edges. The stamping, trimming and piercing operations, when applicable, shall not damage or distort the design or alter the shape of the distinctive unit insignia. The development of the trimming and piercing tools shall be the responsibility of the contractor and shall remain his property at the conclusion of the contract. The contractor shall include a back jack in the stamping operation to include the following minimum information legibly stamped on the reverse of all insignia:

MADE IN USA
(Manufacturer's Hallmark)

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3.7.2 Soldering. Soldered parts shall be completely joined without excess solder and all excess flux shall be removed, joints shall be clean, smooth and free from burned or reduced areas and complete contact shall be made between the soldered parts.

3.7.2.1 Device. When a device is soldered to the base, soft solder shall be used.

3.7.2.2 Prongs. The prongs for the attaching device shall be hard soldered or electronically fused to the insignia. The attaching device shall be the prong and clutch type conforming to TIOH drawing B-13-12 and shall be .3125 inche in length. Two prongs shall be located on the vertical centerline of the insignia equidistant from each end and approximately 7/8 inch on centers. Center dimensions may vary with the design and location adjusted based on the design and piercings. Maximum spread shall be utilized. When tested as specified in 4.4.7.6, the clutch shall not separate from the posts by hand without depressing the release wings.

3.7.3 Enameling. Enamel shall be charged, fired and stoned level with the dikes. The enamel shall then be lapped, fitted or wheel polished to produce a glass like finish. There shall be no overrunning of enamel nor shall the design elements be removed during stoning. Enamel shall be applied so as to be uniform in color, free from bubbles, foreign inclusions, cracking, grazing or other defects which might affect appearance. There shall be no noticeable burn spots as a result of the firing.

3.7.4 Plating. All plating shall be accomplished using electroplating methods. Prior to plating, the insignia shall be cleaned of all matter which may affect the plating. Plating shall be non-porous and continuous over the entire plated surface. There shall be no cut-through, peeling or blistering of the plating. **The use of white metal as an underplating for gold plating shall not be permitted.** Gold colored insignia shall be gold plated and silver color insignia shall be nickel plated unless otherwise specified on the applicable drawing. When tested as specified in 4.4.7.4, there shall be no visible chemical reactions such as evolution of gases.

3.7.5 Lacquering. If Silver plating is specified on the drawing, the entire insignia shall be lacquered. The dry lacquer film shall be continuous, level and adherent and shall be free from lint, dust or other inclusions. All gold or nickel plated insignia may be lacquered at the option of the manufacturer.

3.8 Government loaned property. Dies loaned by the Government shall be used for making distinctive unit insignia for one contract or order and returned to The Institute of Heraldry upon completion. On most contracts it has been found advantageous for the contractor to make his own working dies from the Government furnished dies. Government dies broken or damaged during production

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shall be replaced at the contractor's expense. Damaged Government dies will be returned to The Institute of Heraldry for replacement and replacement costs billed to the contractor.

3.9 Workmanship. The finished insignia shall be clean and meet the acceptable quality levels established by this specification.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISION

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items shall meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspections specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (4.3).

b. Quality conformance inspection (4.4)

4.2.1 Certificate of compliance. Where certificate of compliances are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certificate.

4.3 First article inspection. First article inspection shall be submitted to the Institute of Heraldry (TIOH) on all insignia and a letter of authorization to manufacture will be issued to the contractor prior to production. The examination by TIOH shall be made on a completely finished insignia to ensure all provisions of this specification applicable to end product examination and test are met. A lead strike shall be submitted on ROTC shoulder loop insignia for design approval prior to submission of finished item.

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4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Inspection shall be in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.4.1 Inspection conditions. Unless otherwise specified, all inspections shall be performed in accordance with the test conditions specified herein.

4.4.2 Inspection for acceptance. Inspection shall be in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.4.2.1 Testing of components. In addition to the quality assurance provisions of the subsidiary specifications and drawings, testing shall be performed on components and materials listed in table II for test characteristics shown therein. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the requirements shall be applicable to the lot average.

TABLE II. Component testing.

Components and lots expressed in terms of	Characteristic	Rqm't ref	Test method	#determ per s/u	Results reported	Sample unit
Copper base alloy (1 lb)	Chemical composition	3.5.1	4	2	Nearest 0.1% for	4 oz of material

4.4.3 Certificate of compliance. Components and materials listed below may be accepted on the basis of contractors certification of compliance for requirements specified in applicable paragraphs of this specification.

Component	Characteristic	Rqm't para
Gold for plating	Karat, material identification and white metal not used as underplating	3.5.2 and 3.7.4
Nickel plating	Material identification	3.5.3
Solder	Material identification	3.5.4 and 3.7.2
Lacquer	Material identification	3.5.7
Silver plating	Material identification	3.5.6
Enamel	Material identification	3.5.5

4.4.4 Inspection of the end item.

4.4.4.1 Visual inspection of insignia. The defects found during the examination shall be classified in accordance with 4.4.4.1.1 or 4.4.4.1.2. The lots shall be inspected in accordance with 4.4.4.1.3. The unit of product for examinations shall be one completely fabricated insignia. Examination shall be made at a distance of 16 to 22 inches under normal daylight or its equivalent.

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4.4.4.1.1 Examination of badges for defects in finish design, material, construction, workmanship and marking. Defects designated by an asterisk (*) shall be classified as major when seriously affecting appearance or serviceability and minor when affecting appearance or serviceability but not seriously.

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	(*)	Minor
Finish of metal components	Plating not as specified	x	-	-
	Surface not clean, e.g. foreign matter embedded.	-	*	-
	Buff or drag marks	-	*	-
	Pit, scale, nick, scratch, pinhole crack or other blemish.	-	*	-
	Discoloration, i.e. spot, stain or burn spots	-	*	-
	Plating not continuous, cut through porous or not adherent.	x	-	-
Lacquering	Not completely lacquered when specified.	x	-	-
	Not free of dust, lint and other foreign inclusions.	-	*	-
	Lacquer is not set to touch.	-	-	x
Enameling	Enamel not correct color or shade. . . .	x	-	-
	Not enameled or area of no enamel. . . .	x	-	-
	Not adherent, i.e., blistered, flaking or peeling.	-	*	-
Design	Design does not conform to government die or drawing as applicable.	x	-	-
	Detail struck over, double impression. .	-	*	-
	Any area not pierced as indicated on drawing	x	-	-
	Warp, twist or distortion producing irregular contour or outline.	-	*	-
	Details or letters obliterated or reduced, e.g., enamel stoned out or design excessively stoned.	x	-	-
Construction and workmanship	Any component (including attaching device) missing, bent, twisted, broken, malformed or otherwise impaired	x	-	-
	Not connected or not joined as specified	x	-	-
	Design or shape altered by piercing. . .	x	-	-
	Not trimmed to die-struck edge	-	*	-
	Edges not clean and smooth, e.g., burr, drag, step or roughness	-	*	-

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major (*)		Minor
	Fastening device not positioned as specified	-	-	x
	Solders splatter visible on front and edge of insignia.	x	-	-
	Fastening device is not specified type or size	x	-	-
Marking	Hallmark and "made in USA" not stamped on reverse.	x	-	-

4.4.4.1.2 Examination of insignia for defects in dimension. Any dimension that is not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect.

4.4.4.1.3 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's). The inspection levels and the AQL's expressed in defects per hundred units shall be as follows:

	Inspection level	AQL Major	Total
For defects applicable in 4.4.4.1.1	II	2.5	10.0
For defects applicable in 4.4.4.1.2	S-3	(one class)	4.0

4.4.5 End item testing. Testing of the completely fabricated insignia shall be performed in accordance with table III for the characteristics shown therein. The sample unit for the "Test for Fused Joints" shall be one, the inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 6.5. For end item testing of fused prongs, both prongs on the item will be tested, however not more than one defect will be scored regardless of whether both prongs on the item fail. The sample unit for all other applicable end item test shall be three insignia and the inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL shall be 6.5. The requirements are applicable to the individual unit with one determination per sample unit (except fused prong test). The results shall be reported as pass or fail.

TABLE III. End item testing.

Characteristics	Rqm't para	Test method
Test for soldered and fused joints	3.7.2	4.4.7.2 and 4.4.7.3
Test for gold plating	3.7.4	4.4.7.4
Scratch test for baked enamel	3.7.3	4.4.7.5
Test for clutches	3.7.2.2	4.4.7.6

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4.4.6 Examination for count of insignia in intermediate containers. Insignia packaged for shipment shall be examined to determine conformance with specified or marked quantity. The sample unit for this examination shall be one box (interior package). The lot size shall be the number of intermediate containers. Any box containing less than the specified or marked quantity of insignia shall be classified as a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.4.6.1 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection lot shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

Examination	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any components damaged, affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping or taping, inadequate stapling.
	Bulging or distortion of containers.
Weight	Net weight exceeds requirements.

4.4.7 Tests.

4.4.7.1 Chemical composition test. Chemical composition shall be determined in accordance with test method number III of FED-STD-151. Results shall be evaluated to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.5.1.

4.4.7.2 Test for fused and soldered joints. Items to be tested shall be anchored on a horizontal surface. Both prongs on the end item shall be grasped at least 1/3 its length above the fused joint and bent through and angle of 90 degrees (45 degrees to each side of the vertical). The joints shall then be examined to determine compliance with 3.7.2. A bending tool in the form of a 45 degree template may be used for this test provided the prong is gripped at least 1/3 its length above the fused joint.

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4.4.7.3 Test for hard soldered joints. Insignia shall be placed in an oven maintained at 1065 degrees F. plus or minus 5 degrees F. for 15 minutes. While at this temperature the insignia shall be lifted by the attaching device and shall be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.7.2.

4.4.7.4 Acid test for gold plating. The test acid shall be applied on the insignia as follows: Place a drop of test acid (each drop to be 1/16 inch diameter minimum) on three different spots on the gold plated surface. Allow the drops to remain for not less than 30 seconds. During this time examine the surface to determine compliance with 3.7.4. The test acid applied at room temperature shall consist of a solution containing 50 percent by volume of CP nitric acid (specific gravity 1.42) and an equal volume of distilled water.

4.4.7.5 Test for baked lacquer. Draw a knife edge across the face side of the specimen making four parallel scores 1/16 inch apart. Repeat this process drawing the knife edge this time perpendicular to the previously scored lines, making small blocks in the finish. The finish shall then be examined to determine compliance with 3.7.3.

4.4.7.6 Test for clutches. The clutches shall be removed and replaced on the prong ten times after which they shall be inspected to determine compliance with 3.7.2.2.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A, C or commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging. One insignia shall be mounted with its attaching device on a white sulfite cardboard having a minimum thickness of 0.011 inch. The card shall be approximately 2 inches in length by 2 inches in width. Four cards positioned face to face and back to back shall be wrapped in not less than three thickness of tissue wrap. At the option of the manufacturer, the card may be heat sealed in a transparent polyethylene film bag having a minimum thickness of .002 inch. Prior to the heat sealing operation, excess air within the bag shall be expelled.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packaging. One hundred insignia of one type and size only, prepared as specified in 5.1.1.1, shall be placed front to front and back to back in a set-up paperboard box conforming to type I, variety 1, class A, style 4 of PPP-B-676. The inside dimensions of each paperboard box required shall be determined by the contractor. Any voids occurring within the box shall be filled with cushioning material to prevent shifting of the contents. Box closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the box specification.

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5.1.2 Level C. Insignia shall be preserved and packaged to afford adequate protection against corrosion, deterioration and physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier's commercial practice will be acceptable when it fulfills the above requirements.

5.1.3 Commercial. Insignia shall be preserved in accordance with the applicable requirements of ASTM-D-3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, C or commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Insignia of one type only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to class weather-resistant, V3c or V3s of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the box specification. The weight limitations of the container specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Insignia of one type only, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting shipping container conforming to class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Insignia, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with the rules and regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.2.4 Commercial. Insignia shall be preserved in accordance with the applicable requirements of ASTM-D-3951.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, intermediate boxes and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.1 Intermediate packages. Each intermediate package shall be legibly marked with the information listed below.

NOMENCLATURE
QUANTITY
CONTRACT NUMBER

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Insignia covered by this specification are intended to be worn by military personnel and cadets to indicate unit or organization.

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6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Insignia title and date of the applicable drawing (see 3.1).
(c) Motto or inscription specified on the applicable insignia drawing (see 3.1).
(d) When a standard sample will not be furnished.
(e) When a first article is not required (3.4).
(f) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 Detail requirements. This specification should be used in conjunction with the applicable drawing which lists detailed requirements of the insignia to be procured (see 3.1).

6.4 First article. When a first article inspection is required, the item should be a first article sample. The contracting officer may not require first article inspection if the contractor has a previous letter of certification by the Institute of Heraldry for the specific insignia being procured (see 4.3). The first article will be submitted to the Institute of Heraldry and should consist of five completed insignia.

6.5 Government loaned dies. Certified manufacturers who are the successful bidder may request loan of government dies from the following address:

The Institute of Heraldry
Building 15, Cameron Station
Alexandria, Virginia 22304-5050

6.6 Quality conformance. The contracting officer may forward five insignia from the shipment to the Institute of Heraldry for testing of conformance.

6.7 Changes from previous issue. This is the initial publication of this specification.

6.8 Subject term (key word) listing.

Distinctive insignia
Distinctive unit insignia
Unit insignia
Shoulder loop insignia
Prong and clutch
Attaching device
Gold plated
Gilding metal
Nickel plated

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Custodians:
Army - IH

Review activities:
DLA - CT

Preparing activity:
Army - IH

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-I-14654(IH)	Insignia, Distinctive Unit and Shoulder Loop

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

(TO DETACH THIS FORM, CUT ALONG THIS LINE.)

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